



e-waste (Image courtesy: Greenpeace India)

that have reached the dead-end, according to the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM).

India generates over 440,000 tonnes of e-waste annually, which is growing at a rate of about 20 per cent annually. Almost half of all the unused and end-of-life electronic products lies in landfills, junkyards and warehouses.

Computer equipment account for almost 68 per cent of e-waste material followed by telecommunication equipment (12 per cent), electrical equipment (8 per cent), medical equipment (7 per cent) and other equipment including the household e-crap accounting for the remaining five per cent.

"Over 90 per cent of the e-waste generated in India is managed by the unorganised sector and the scrap dealers in this market dismantle the disposed of products instead of recycling the same," said D.S. Rawat, secretary general of ASSOCHAM, while releasing the findings of the chamber's analysis.

ELCINA to launch electronics manufacturing cluster

ELCINA, in partnership with Vittal Innovation City, plans to launch its first electronics manufacturing cluster site in Ananthpur district near Bengaluru. This facility will provide an efficient and low-cost environment enabling manufacturers to compete globally.

ELCINA said that it began work on this initiative in 2009 and had submitted a detailed proposal in 2009 to DeitY (then DIT) for establishing such clusters to bring "real progress and high value-added electronics manufacturing to India."

The central government will provide financial

support of up to Rs 500 million for investments in common infrastructure.

Modular and PC-based test instruments sales growing

According to a report by Frost & Sullivan, the market for modular and PC-based test instruments earned revenues of over Rs 4927 million in 2011. It is expected to reach Rs 7074.8 million in 2018 with customers increasingly investing in these instruments for their portability and relative cost-effectiveness.

Rapid growth in infrastructure and technologies such as 3G and 4G augurs well for the Indian general-purpose test equipment market, as the higher frequency, bandwidth and number of applications spawn a parallel need for integrated test equipment.

While the demand for modular and

PC-based test instruments is growing, cautious customers are still reluctant to increase their capital expenditure and buy high-end general-purpose test equipment, preferring instead to rent the equipment, particularly when only one-time use is required for completing a project.

Annual supplement to foreign trade policy announced

Anand Sharma, minister for commerce, industry and textiles, recently announced the annual supplement (2012-13) to the Foreign Trade Policy 2009-14.

Some helpful changes have been made in the Export Promotion Capital Goods (EPCG) scheme. Green technology products have also found some support. Moreover, some welcome simplification has been made in the irksome procedures.

Electronics and IT hardware manufacturing industries feature in special focus initiatives. The specific announcements for electronics and IT hardware manufacturing industries are export of electronic goods incentivised under focus product scheme, expeditious clearance of approvals required from Directorate General of Foreign Trade, exporters/associations entitled to utilise market access initiative and marketing development assistance schemes for promoting electronics and IT hardware manufacturing industries' exports, and electronics sector included for benefits under SHIS scheme.



PC-based multimeter (Image courtesy: National Instruments)